



TAKING STOCK: CM Raje at a blast site (left); victims in a hospital

The police and intelligence agencies, caught in the political blame game, are not conditioned or trained to counter such terrorist threats

cycle that had a live bomb which was defused and released a sketch of the buyer. Many Muslim families here have relatives in Pakistan which is exploited by agencies on the other side to develop their channels. There are also a huge number of illegal Bangladeshis in Rajasthan but local politics and lack of coordination has hampered efforts to deport them in any large numbers. Given their economic background—mostly poor—the intelligence agencies feel that besides their religion, it makes them more susceptible to instigation by terror groups. On Wednesday evening, a TV channel received a video showing a cycle with a blue packet on its carrier, taken before the blasts, and a warning but it is still to be confirmed by the investigating agencies.

What has caused widespread anger is the belief that both state and Central intelligence agencies have failed in terms of information or providing adequate security. Although in the inevitable blame game, the state Government says that it had no specific inputs from the Centre, a

senior Home Ministry official had told INDIA TODAY three weeks ago, "I apprehend attack on lesser known but crowded temples instead of prominent ones." Rajasthan's 1,000 km long border with Pakistan makes the state susceptible to infiltration as also a route for contraband and arms.

Irrespective of which party rules in Rajasthan, the police and intelligence setups show an amateur understanding of terror acts in the country and their implications in the state. The state police and intelligence invariably join the state Government in blaming the Centre for such acts. Chief Minister Vasundhara Raje said the blasts were "very disturbing" but demanded more help from the Centre to combat the threat: "It is an intolerable act but we did not receive any specific input from the Centre on Jaipur." Amid all this political oneupmanship, and with state elections approaching, people of Jaipur have very little faith in the police or the Government to be able to curb such attacks. The city limped back to normalcy but with the knowledge that life would never be the same again. ■

